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Assignment #3

Company Overview

This past summer I worked at a company called Pacific Capacitor Co., which manufactures electronic components. They specifically produce high voltage mica capacitors for satellite communications, military defense, radar systems, autonomous vehicles, cancer treatment, and X-ray.

Internship Overview

My role at this company is called Marketing and Communications Associate. I was promoted from my previous role as Quality Control Analyst at the company. For this marketing role, I managed the design and launch of a new company website, developed a professional brochure for customers highlighting product offerings and technical capabilities, created a company presentation to support training and for customers, and managed customer visits by setting up the event room accordingly with proper ambiance and product displays. I still currently have this role at Pacific Capacitor Co., but I am looking for a full time position following graduation from Santa Clara University. My hours over the summer were part time, about 12 hours a week, in addition to the several hours I worked under Quality Control Analyst. I am currently working both positions.

Internship Insights

I led the creation of the new company website and had periodic check ins with management about my progress and suggestions I should implement. I used Squarespace to create the website, and I found it interesting there is no training or classes that you can take for something like this; you simply have to figure it out as you go. I never used a platform like Squarespace or any other website building platform. It was interesting to see how much I learned just by figuring things out on my own, and with the help of Chat GPT telling me where certain buttons are on the platform.

I learned that having a background in basic marketing principles did assist me in this job. The company already had an established color scheme and persona, but it wasn't implemented as best as it could be. I took the time to establish a brand style guide to keep everything I created visually consistent. This brand style guide has the full color palette with all of the color schemes of the company and the appropriate typefaces and fonts. It was interesting to see how this wasn't implemented in writing prior to my role. It was discussed that the company did not have a prior need to have relevant and updated promotional materials until now.

In the upcoming months, once I get settled into the new school year, I will work on using Google Analytics and SEO practices to boost the website's reachability and performance. This is another thing that I have never done before, so it will be interesting to see what I will learn from that experience, and how that could potentially assist me in future opportunities. One person on the team suggested naming images and files that are uploaded onto the website. This can allow Google to automatically put the website higher when searching for certain things because of those repeated words that are embedded in the file names. In this case, I would use words such as "high voltage mica capacitor" for naming the content files.

Surprising Takeaways

I was surprised at how approachable my manager was compared to what I expected. I was expecting to see a clear hierarchy in terms of my status at the company versus their years of experience. However, everybody treated me as I was one of them and I felt no ounce of intimidation to approach them because they were very open and easy to talk to. I was also surprised at the amount of independence that I was trusted with in my responsibilities. With some basic guidance, I felt very open to create and design things, and it was nice not to constantly have an authority over my shoulder saying what I should change. After major milestones in the creation of the website and other supporting materials, I did have meetings with my supervisor and occasionally the CEO to get their input. I made changes based off of their commentary. However, it was nice to be able to implement certain design choices or page layouts according to what I felt was best and have those be used because they truly liked what I did with my fresh perspective.

It was rewarding to see how my work truly impacted this company in a positive way. It will allow them to have more of a competitive edge compared to their competitors because of all of the relevant materials and online presence. It was nice to not be stuck with busywork the entire time and how I actually had an impact. In turn, I learned a lot of new skills that I feel I will be implementing in future roles I come across.

It was also interesting to notice the company culture. Every Friday someone brings in bagels or donuts for everybody to enjoy. The company also provides complementary car detailing every Wednesday to a different employee each week. There were also some other benefits such as health insurance, but I did not qualify for that, so the specifics are vague.

Internship Experience into Job Interviews

Throughout this internship, I learned how to manage and coordinate projects independently, while still being part of a team. I can collaborate with other people's ideas, hearing their opinions on my work and not think they are wrong if they have a suggestion that I don't immediately like or see the point of. I also gained hard skills from this position such as creating websites with Squarespace, Autodesk Fusion (a design tool), Google Analytics, and I honed my event planning skills. I also got more confident talking with professionals that have been at this company for several decades. I thought it would've been intimidating, and at the beginning it was, but my skills have improved from this experience in that regard.

I personally want to go into the B2B tech side of marketing, which I'm aware is contrary to the Retail Studies minor. This is because when I first started out at Santa Clara University, I really wanted to go into retail, but my goals have changed since then. I still find retail very interesting, so when I go into an interview for the type of marketing role that I'm looking for, I will have a diverse background of experiences and exposure to business to business and business to customer.

EMPAC Model

Under Convenience, it was interesting to see how much effort went into making the purchasing process easy for customers. The company has a standard order fulfillment timeline of eight weeks, but if the customer is highly valued, their shipments can be fulfilled quicker. Additionally, if a customer has no other option and is extremely reliant on Pacific Capacitor Co., this would be a good opportunity for the company to fulfill their order quicker and create those good customer ties. There are even smaller instances where one of the supervisors would take time to help a customer out with product use or resolve any issues that came up. From the

customers point of view, Pacific Capacitor Co. is a trusted ally because they will help you with getting the product you need, when you need it.

For Price and Promotion, since this is a manufacturing company and not a retailer, there are no flashy discounts that attract customers. Pacific mainly focuses on customer retention and will give price discounts based off of volume ordered and what the capacitor was. For example, if it is a completely new design that a customer specifically requested, a premium may be put in place in case of potential product failures or damages that take time to resolve. If the new design is successful, the customer will be pleased with the company's determination of custom solutions and has a high likelihood of returning. This helps foster a strong relationship between Pacific and their loyal customers, allowing the price per capacitor to be flexible.

Conclusion

In the end, I had a very positive experience with my new role at Pacific Capacitor Co. this summer. I was proud of myself for taking on such responsibility within a professional workplace and doing it successfully. I hope to apply the skills I have learned into my future endeavors and other job opportunities that will come my way.